

What a screen reader misses on an insurer's website

A short accessibility check against the 35 WCAG criteria that apply to private businesses in Norway · 11 September 2026

I looked at the insurer's main site, six of its terms documents, its recruitment site and its design system portal.

Sample copy. The organisation's name, its products, its file names and its class names have been taken out. The findings, the measurements and the fixes are as they were sent.

Wioleta Maria Wójcik, service designer and architect wioletawojcik.com

One set of notes from a series of thirteen, written for the organisation and sent to it with its name on: **five notes, each with the fix written next to it.**

FIRST, WHAT ALREADY WORKS

- I measured contrast against the composed background on **550 text elements** across five pages of the main site. **Not one failure.** Every element I reached with the Tab key showed a focus ring, a 3 pixel dark outline that measures **18.9:1** on white and 18.3:1 on the coloured sub-navigation.
- All **365 controls** on those pages have an accessible name and all **32 images** carry an alt attribute, the 14 decorative ones correctly empty. The search field has a real `<label for>`. In the car insurance quote the step indicator names the current step and the steps not yet begun, so a listener knows where they are in a purchase.
- The front page reflows at **320 pixels** with no horizontal scrollbar, no id is used twice, and zoom is not blocked. You publish an accessibility statement with its own inbox, which a private company is not required to publish at all, and your design system pages put an **accessibility champion in almost every digital team.**

The pages people buy from are in good order. The four failures below are not in them. They sit where a design system does not reach: a document platform, a recruitment platform, and one attribute in the header component. **Three of the four are fixed once, in one place, for every page they touch.** What follows is four specific problems and one judgement call.

2.4.1 Bypass Blocks Level A

1. The skip link has nowhere to go, and the place it needs is already there

```
<a href="#" class="skip">Hopp til innhold</a>
<main id="content">
```

WHAT I SAW The first thing the Tab key reaches on the main site is *Hopp til innhold*, and it appears as a coloured chip in the top left exactly as it should. Its `href` is `#`. I pressed Enter: focus stayed on the link, nothing scrolled, and the next Tab went to the logo. The same component, down to the class name, is on the design system portal as *Skip to content*.

THE EFFECT	Between that link and the first line of the page there are 14 more stops : the logo, four segment tabs, five menu buttons, search, basket, claims and login. Someone who moves by keyboard passes all 14 on every page, on every visit. The one control that exists to spare them that is the one that does nothing. For a person using a screen reader the same 14 are read out first.
THE FIX	<code>href="#content"</code> , plus <code>tabindex="-1"</code> on the <code><main></code> so focus itself lands inside the page. One attribute, in one component, on two sites. The id it needs is the one your CMS already writes.

1.3.1 Info and Relationships Level A

3.1.1 Language of Page Level A

2. The terms documents are untagged, and all six carry the same internal title

```
car-insurance-terms.pdf    16 pages
StructTreeRoot: none      /Lang: none    bookmarks: 0
Title: [the same internal name on all six]  written by the document platform, June
2026
```

WHAT I SAW	I opened the general terms behind three car products, two travel products and one home product. Six documents, 103 pages. None has a structure tree, so none has a single heading, list or table a screen reader can use. None declares a language. None has bookmarks. All six carry the same document title, and it is not the name of a product.
THE EFFECT	A 16 page policy arrives as one unbroken run of text, with no way to jump to <i>Hva forsikringen dekker</i> or to the excess. Without a language the Norwegian is spoken by whatever voice the reader is set to, often an English one. And because the title is the same internal name on every one, a person with four policies open cannot tell which is which. This is the document you read before you buy, and the one you go back to on the day something has happened.
THE FIX	Tagged output, document language and a real title are settings in the document platform's template. Set once, they apply to every terms document in every product line, and to what the system sends out after that.

1.3.1 Info and Relationships Level A

3. Every job advert has a different heading structure, and some headings are empty

```
<h1>[the job title]</h1>
<h3>&nbsp;</h3>
<h4><strong>Om programmet</strong></h4>
<h4>&nbsp;</h4>
```

WHAT I SAW	I read four adverts. The graduate advert goes from the h1 to an empty h3, then six h4s, two of them also empty. An analytics advert goes to eight h3s, one empty. A key account advert has seven h3s. The developer advert has no headings in the advert at all: its sections are paragraphs in bold. On all four, the only h2 on the page is the template's own, below everything else.
------------	--

THE EFFECT	Pulling up the heading list is how many people read a long page they have not seen. Here that list is either empty, or it has entries with nothing in them, announced as "heading level 3" and then silence. An advert is a page somebody reads when they are deciding whether they belong at your company , and four adverts read four different ways.
THE FIX	Give the advert body one set of levels in the editor, starting at h2, and drop headings whose only content is a space. This is a decision about the writing tool. Each of these four was typed by a different person doing their best with a rich text box.

1.4.3 Contrast (Minimum) Level AA

4. The only heading on the job search page is white on white

```
<h1>Søkeresultater for "tjenestedesigner".</h1>
color: rgb(255,255,255) background behind it: rgb(255,255,255) ratio 1:1
```

WHAT I SAW	On the recruitment site's search page the page's only h1 is 1000 pixels wide and 21 high, painted white on the white panel behind it. I measured it against what is actually painted underneath, and there is no image or gradient anywhere in that stack. The ratio is 1:1 where 4.5:1 is asked. It is white with a keyword, without one, and on a search that returns nothing.
THE EFFECT	A person listening hears the heading. Everyone else gets a page with no visible title at all. The sentence below it, <i>Det finnes for øyeblikket ingen ledige stillinger som passer...</i> , is visible, so nobody is left without the answer. What is missing is the line that says which search this is , and it is missing only for the people who can see.
THE FIX	One colour token in the career site theme. If the heading is meant to be invisible, your own site already does that properly: the main site hides its front page h1 with a screen-reader-only class, which keeps it out of the layout as well.

The h1 on the front page A judgement call, not a failure

5. Your busiest page announces itself by its domain name

```
<h1 class="sr-only">[the domain name]</h1>
<h2 class="title uppercase">[the sentence people see]</h2>
```

WHAT I SAW	The h1 on the front page is hidden from view and reads the domain name. The line people see, the sentence the company greets people with, is an h2. Product pages do it the other way: the product name is a visible h1, and so is the headline on the career page.
MY VIEW	I would not report this as a failure. There is an h1, there is only one, and the page works. But the first thing read out on the page most of your customers land on is a domain name, and the sentence you chose to greet people with sits a level below it. The design system portal has the same pattern and announces itself by its own domain name.
THE FIX	Promote the visible line to h1 and let the hidden one go. Nothing moves on screen.

WHAT THE REGULATIONS REQUIRE

The regulations on universal design of ICT hold private businesses in Norway to **35 WCAG success criteria**: the level A and AA criteria of WCAG 2.0, without the three on time-based media. Your own accessibility pages name that number. The twelve criteria WCAG 2.1 added, reflow among them, are on the public sector list of 48, not on yours. The European Accessibility Act has applied in the EU since June 2025; in Norway the implementation is delayed and carries no date. **Notes 1 to 4 are failures against the 35. Note 5 is not, and I have marked it as what it is.**

One thing I would put on a list without calling it a finding: the public accessibility statement promises at least AA in WCAG 2.0, while the statement on the design system portal, updated in March, says **WCAG 2.1**. The public one is a version behind the one your own teams work to. Three more I found and did not write up: on the Norwegian job list, six of the twenty adverts are Danish or Swedish titles inside a container marked `lang="nb-N0"`, while the language switcher three lines above them carries `da-DK` and `sv-SE` correctly; two cookie buttons on the recruitment site carry `tabindex="1"` and take the first two tab stops, ahead of its skip link; and three id values are used more than once there, which stopped being a failure of its own when 4.1.1 was withdrawn in WCAG 2.2.

What I did not check, and I would rather say so: everything behind login, which is where a customer's real business with you happens; the apps; a run with a real screen reader; the interest form you host on a third-party forms service; and the contrast of text sitting on photographs, which needs eyes and not a script.

AREAS OF WORK

The files that belong to no team

The design system does what it is for, and the champions sit where the work is, one in almost every team. Both of those are organised by team. **The two failures that matter most are in files no team owns: a policy document written by a document platform, and an advert typed into a recruitment platform.** There is no squad whose board they appear on, and no component to fix. That is service design work: naming who owns an output, deciding where it is checked, and writing the list short enough that the person who owns it can actually use it.

The document you read on the worst day

I trained as an architect, and a building's escape plan is judged by one thing: how it reads to someone who has never studied it, on the day they need it. **A policy is that plan for an insurance product.** 103 pages across six documents, with no headings to move by and no title to tell them apart, is a plan drawn to be filed. Structure is the same job as wayfinding in a building: decide what a person needs to find first, and make it findable in the order they meet it.

This is a view from outside, and a starting list. The rest of what I have done is in the CV.

ABOUT THIS COPY

The organisation received this document with its name on it.

This is one of thirteen sets of notes written between August and September 2026 for Norwegian organisations. The name, the products, the file names and the class names have been taken out; the findings, the measurements and the fixes are as they were sent. What the thirteen had in common is at wioletawojcik.com/accessibility.html.